



Intercultural Literacy

Spring, 2026

Course No.	HA2309 (Elective)	Classroom	(3)1: 탐구 2209 (3)2: 탐구 2409-2	Credits	3 Credits 3 hours/ 16 weeks
Instructor	Kevin Anderson (anderson@ksa.hs.kr)			Office Hours	(3)1: 월 (3,4) 금 (2) (3)2: 수 (5) 목 (7,8)

Required Google Classroom Class Codes:

Class 1: afaeh3lx

Class 2: iie3cavy

Course Overview

Description

As a senior-level elective course, Intercultural Literacy introduces students to the origins of modern global culture, moving from the migration of early *Homo Sapiens* to the algorithmic feeds of today. Students will enhance their advanced language skills while fostering critical thinking about cultural identity, diversity, and global interdependence. They will analyze the economic systems that underpin globalization, the influence of American pop culture, and the friction caused by immigration and nationalism. Finally, we will examine the changing face of Korean identity in a digital world. By the end of the course, students will not only have improved their English proficiency but also developed the awareness and empathy necessary for effective and responsible intercultural interaction.

This course treats all ideas—progressive, conservative, nationalist, globalist, traditional, modern—as equally open to rigorous examination. No belief is granted special protection from critique simply because it is fashionable, uncomfortable, or tied to identity. Students will be expected to support their positions with empirical evidence, logical consistency, and clear reasoning, and to extend the same standard to every perspective encountered.

Objectives

- Develop advanced English reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills.
- Explore diverse cultural frameworks (historical, economic, and environmental).
- Critically analyze intercultural communication, media narratives, and "soft power."
- Build empathy and competence as global citizens by reflecting on personal and national identity.

CORE Competencies

- **Critical Thinking:** Critical thinking refers to an intellectually disciplined process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing, synthesizing, and/or evaluating information gathered from observation, experience, reflection, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to belief and action.
- **Communication (in English):** This refers to the ability of an individual to accurately convey a message to another person or group of people. There are verbal and non-verbal communication skills. The course emphasizes communication using the English language.
- **Insights:** From a liberal arts perspective, insight refers to immediate and clear learning or understanding that takes place without overt trial-and-error testing. Insight happens when people recognize relationships (or make novel associations between objects or actions) that can help them solve new problems.
- **Empathy:** Empathy here does not mean emotional agreement or feeling sorry for others. It refers to the cognitive skill of accurately modeling another person's worldview, values, and evidence base in order to critique it effectively and fairly.
- **Team Leadership:** This refers to one's competence that supports the diverse skills, needs, goals, perspectives, and expectations of independent team members while connecting the work of the team with the broad organizational goals.

Textbook & References

- **Textbook:** No required textbook. Reading materials will be provided as handouts.
- **Reference:** Selected readings from Yuval Noah Harari, Ray Dalio, Douglas Murray, etc.
- **Web & Multimedia Resources:** YouTube, Google, Netflix (for film screening).

Course Requirements & Assessment

Attendance	Class Participation	Project 1	Mid-term Exam (Written Test)	Project 2
20%	15%	15%	25%	25%

- **Attendance (20%):** Regular attendance is essential for full participation in discussions and collaborative learning activities. Students are expected to attend all classes and actively engage. Lateness of 5 minutes will result in a .5-point deduction. Being more than 15 minutes late as well as unexcused absences will result in a full 1-point deduction.
- **Class Participation (15%):** This includes participation in class discussions, small group tasks, and structured debates. Students will be assessed on their willingness to contribute, ability to express ideas clearly, and respect for diverse perspectives.
- **Project 1 (15%):** Students will complete an individual presentation related to the themes discussed in the class. The topic is "Cultural Artifacts That Shaped Me." Assessment will consider creativity, depth of content, and delivery.
- **Mid-term Exam (Written Test) (25%):** The mid-term will assess students' understanding of key concepts covered in the first half of the course (Weeks 1–7) through a written exam that includes short answers, essay questions, and analysis of readings.
- **Project 2 (25%):** Students will complete a final video project. The topic is "How Culture A has Influenced Culture B." This assignment will be evaluated for content depth, organization, intercultural insight, and language use.

Final Grade: A+ (95~100), A0 (90~94), A- (85~89), B+(80~84), B0 (75~79), B- (70~74), C+(66~69), C0 (63~65), C- (60~62), D+ (56~59), D0 (50~55), D- (45~49), F (44 and below)

Attendance Requirement: To earn credits, you must attend at least 3/4 of the total class hours.

Grading for Absentee Students: If a baseline score cannot be calculated for an absentee's "acknowledged score" (make-up score), the average score of performance assessments will be used as the baseline. (Please refer to the "Academic Achievement Management Regulations" for the specific reflection ratio of these scores.)

Exception for Paper-Based Exams: Notwithstanding the above, according to Article 10, Paragraph 3 of the Academic Achievement Management Regulations—which states, "Regardless of whether a baseline score can be calculated, if the subject teacher deems it necessary, a separate paper-based evaluation for the absentee student may be conducted following a consultation with the Academic Department Council" (Amended March 11, 2025)—a separate paper-based exam may be administered.

Weekly Schedule

** The following schedule and readings are subject to change upon necessity. Any change will be announced ahead of time in class.*

WEEK	THEMES AND ACTIVITIES	NOTES
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1 (Feb. 23-27)	THE ROOTS OF CULTURE • FOCUS: <i>Homo Sapiens</i> as migrants; biology, climate, and geography's role in culture. • READING: (excerpt), Jared Diamond, "The Shape of Africa", "The Rice Theory of Culture" by Thomas Talhelm	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
2 (March 3-6)	UNDERSTANDING CULTURE AND IDENTITY • FOCUS: What shapes our cultural identities? • READING: "The Coddling of the American Mind" by Greg Lukianoff & Jonathan Haidt, "Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions"	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
3 (March 9-13)	THE ECONOMIC ENGINE OF GLOBALISM • FOCUS: How money shapes the world; Gold Standard, Bretton Woods, Keynesianism. • READING: "Time Preference" by Saifedean Ammous	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
4 (March 16-20)	AMERICAN CULTURAL HEGEMONY PART I (ROOTS) • FOCUS: Origins of soft power; Jazz, Blues, and the African-American experience. • READING: The Painful Birth of Blues and Jazz by Stephanie Hall	

CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
5 (March 23-27)	AMERICAN CULTURAL HEGEMONY PART II (GLOBALIZATION) • FOCUS: Disco, Hip-hop, Electronic music; US pop culture as "default." • READING: Japanese Hip-Hop and the Globalization of Popular Culture by Ian Condry	Open Class Week
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
6 (March 30-April 3)	PROJECT 1: Cultural Artifacts That Shaped Me PRESENTATIONS • FOCUS: Students present 3-5 personal objects/media explaining how they intersect cultures/identities. (7 Minutes).	1st Project Due
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
7 (April 6-10,13)	BABEL FILM SCREENING • FOCUS: In-class screening of Babel (2006). Discussion on interconnectedness and communication breakdown.	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
8 (April 14-17)	MID-TERM EXAM WEEK	No Class

9 (April 20-24)	IMMIGRATION • FOCUS: Migrant crisis; "Suicidal Empathy"; politicization of borders. • READING: Excerpt from "The Strange Death of Europe" by Douglas Murray	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
10 (April 27- May 1)	THE MEDIA SHIFT & NARRATIVE CONTROL • FOCUS: Cultural narratives shaped by global media, Legacy vs. New Media • READING: Andrey Mir "How the Media Polarized Us"	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
11 (May 4-8)	CULTURAL HYBRIDITY: BLENDING, INNOVATION, AND IDENTITY • FOCUS: How cultures remix ; benefits vs. risks of hybridity; role in personal/national • READING: "The Case for Contamination" by Kwame Anthony Appiah	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
12 (May 11-15)	A CHANGING WORLD ORDER • FOCUS: Asia reclaiming its cultural significance • MEDIA: Balaji Srinivasan: The COLLAPSE of the West	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	

13 (May 18-22)	GLOBAL KOREA • FOCUS: The Rise of Korean Soft Power and the Transformation of Tradition • READING: Michelle Zauner's Crying in H Mart (excerpt)	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
14 (May 26-29)	THE DIGITAL SELF & GLOBAL CITIZENSHIP • FOCUS: Algorithms, gamification of life, loss of real-world connection. • READING: Ted Chiang's "ChatGPT is a Blurry JPEG of the Web", Yuval Noah Harari, "The Medieval Olympics"	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
15 (June 1-5)	MAKE-UP MATERIAL & PROJECT 2: THE YOUTUBE SCREENINGS	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
16 (June 8-12)	PROJECT 2: THE YOUTUBE SCREENINGS	2nd Project Due
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy	
17 (June 15-19)	FINAL EXAM WEEK (NO CLASS)	No Class

